NeverCrisis Offline Setup Guide

This guide sets up FINAL FANTASY VII EVER CRISIS to run offline on your own PC with the NeverCrisis server. It takes about an hour, most of it copying files.

Before you start

You need three things:

- **The game installed through Steam.** Steam can tell you where it is: right-click the game in your Library, then **Manage** → **Browse local files**. The usual place is `C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\steamapps\common\FF7EC`.
- **At least 50 GB of free space** on any drive, and more is safer. You will make a full copy of the game, and the biggest folder (`octo`) alone is over 46 GB. The game's size on disk varies between installs and can be well over 50 GB, so check the size of your own Steam folder first (right-click it, then **Properties**).
- **The NeverCrisis release zip** (version 1.0.0) from the NeverCrisis GitHub page. Download it and leave it zipped for now.

A few terms used below:

- **Game folder** means the new copy you make in Step 1, for example `D:\FF7EC`. Every step after Step 1 uses this copy, never the Steam one.
- **Extract** means opening the zip and copying its contents out. In Windows, right-click the zip and pick **Extract All...**, or double-click it and drag the contents out.

Step 1: Copy the game to its own folder

The offline game runs from a separate copy so Steam updates can't change it.

1. Open the Steam game folder (see **Before you start** above).
2. Go up one level so you can see the `FF7EC` folder itself.
3. Copy the whole `FF7EC` folder: right-click it and pick **Copy**.
4. Open where you want the copy, for example a second drive like `D:\`, then right-click an empty spot and pick **Paste**.
5. Wait for the copy to finish. It usually takes 10 to 30 minutes, but on a slower drive it can take a few hours. Make sure the `octo` folder came across, since it is most of the size.

From now on, "game folder" means this copy, for example `D:\FF7EC`.

Step 2: Add the NeverCrisis files

1. Open the NeverCrisis zip. You will see a `save` folder and some files, including `FF7ECServer`.
2. Copy everything **except** the `save` folder into your game folder.

3. Windows will say two files already exist. Choose **Replace the files in the destination**.

Keep the zip handy: you need the `save` folder in Step 4. Do not put it in the game folder.

Step 3: First launch

The first launch creates your offline player number. You'll play properly in Step 5.

1. In your game folder, right-click `FF7ECServer` and pick **Run as administrator**. Click **Yes** when Windows asks.
2. A black server window opens and the game starts. Leave the black window open.
3. Wait for the game's title screen, then close the game.
4. Click the black server window and press **Ctrl + C** to stop the server. If it doesn't close, close the window.

Prefer the command prompt? Open the Start menu, type `cmd`, right-click **Command Prompt** and pick **Run as administrator**. Then type these two lines, using your own game folder, and press Enter after each:

```
cd /d D:\FF7EC
FF7ECServer
```

Step 4: Copy the save data into My Games

This is the step most people get wrong. The `save` folder from the zip goes into your Documents, not the game folder.

1. **Find your player number.** In the game folder, open `ff7ec_account_id.txt` (double-click opens it in Notepad). It holds one long number, for example `123456789012345678`.
2. **Open your My Games folder.** Click the address bar at the top of File Explorer, paste `%USERPROFILE%\Documents\My Games\FF7EC\Steam` and press Enter. If that isn't found, your Documents may be in OneDrive: try `%USERPROFILE%\OneDrive\Documents\My Games\FF7EC\Steam`.
3. **Open the folder named with your player number.** It already has `LocalizeData` and `MasterData` folders in it. That's expected.
4. **Copy the save data in.** Open the `save` folder in the NeverCrisis zip, select the `LocalizeData` and `MasterData` folders inside it, and copy them into your player-number folder.
5. When Windows asks, choose **Replace the files in the destination**.

When you're done, the path should look like `...\My Games\FF7EC\Steam\123456789012345678\MasterData`, with your own number.

Step 5: Start playing

1. Run `FF7ECServer` as administrator again, the same way as Step 3.
2. The game should now ask you to create an account name. Pick one and play.

Every time you play: run `FF7ECServer` as administrator from your game folder. Don't start the game from Steam, which uses the online copy. To quit, close the game, then press **Ctrl + C** in the server window.

Tip: right-click `FF7ECServer` and pick **Send to** → **Desktop (create shortcut)**. Then right-click the shortcut, pick **Properties** → **Advanced...**, and tick **Run as administrator** so the desktop icon always works.

Optional: Bring over your old account or add gear

All of these change `account.json` in your game folder's `data` folder. Before any of them: **stop the server, and make a backup copy of** `account.json` (copy it and paste it next to the original).

Bring over your old account. If you have your EOS account export (a `.json` file), open the EOS Player Stats page and expand **Export to a NeverCrisis offline server**. Pick your export and your game folder's `data\account.json`, click **Build**, and replace `data\account.json` with the file it downloads. Your level, characters, weapons, materia, items, progress and stones come over. Gifts, friends and guild data don't. If you prefer, the Python scripts shared in the Discord community do the same job.

Add outfits or weapons, such as Golden Flower Kimono. On the same page, expand **Add outfits & weapons to a NeverCrisis account**. Upload `data\account.json`, tick what you want (search by name or character), click **Add and download**, and replace `data\account.json` with the downloaded file. Weapons arrive as a fresh 5★ copy. Anything you already own is skipped.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
Black screen after launching	The `save` data is in the wrong place. Redo Step 4, and remove any `save` folder you put in the game folder.
Stuck on "Connecting..."	Usually the same cause as a black screen: redo Step 4. Also check the server window is still open.
No player-number folder in My Games	Step 3 didn't finish. Run it again and wait for the title screen before closing.
Can't find `My Games`	Your Documents may be in OneDrive. Try the OneDrive path in Step 4.
Windows warns about `FF7ECServer`	Windows SmartScreen or your antivirus may flag it because it's not a well-known program. Click **More info** → **Run anyway** if you trust the download.
Game asks for an update or goes online	You started it from Steam. Close it and run `FF7ECServer` from your game folder or your desktop shortcut instead.
Account file changes didn't show up	Change `account.json` only while the server is stopped, then start it again.